

Arpan Bakshi

Sustainability Go-to-Market and Carbon Strategy Lead

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Based in London, UK and US citizen

GO-TO-MARKET FOR CARBON AND SUSTAINABILITY | WHOLE LIFE CARBON | AI-ASSISTED WORK

SINCE 2008	I have sold and launched sustainability services to the developers, contractors, manufacturers and public clients who buy LCA software, at Foster + Partners, SOM and WSP.
COMMERCIAL	At Foster + Partners I co-created and launched a strategic advisory service line and led pitches that won more than £10 million a year in fees.
CARBON	I sat on the whole life carbon leadership team, built early design tools that estimate whole life carbon, correlated the firm's rating systems into one framework of ten themes and trained studio partners on embodied carbon and coming regulation.
AI	I co-founded Atlas Learn, where I run sales, marketing and commercial operations and have trained more than 250 senior professionals to use AI tools.
LCA COMMUNITY	I spoke on a One Click LCA Bootcamp panel in 2023 and organised the London LCA Forum in 2022.

Experience

Atlas Learn

Oct 2025 to Present

London

Co-Founder

Atlas Learn trains executive teams and senior professionals to use AI tools in their daily work.

- Designed and delivered training for the board of directors of a FinTech company, and for another client's chief executive and its heads of HR, marketing and IT.
- Trained more than 250 senior professionals to use Claude Code, Cowork and other AI tools in workshops held in Central London.
- Design the company's courses and run its sales, marketing and commercial operations.

Foster + Partners

Oct 2015 to Jul 2026

London

Revenue £653m (FY2025)

Associate Partner, 2020 to 2026 · Associate, 2015 to 2020

Foster + Partners is an architecture and engineering practice with about 2,500 staff. Its buildings include Lusail Stadium, the Gherkin, Bloomberg's London headquarters, Apple Park and JPMorgan Chase's New York headquarters.

ADVISORY AND BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT

- Co-created and launched a strategic advisory service line that took the firm into corporate environmental strategy, digital transformation and spatial consulting.
- Pitched, negotiated and won a multi-year contract with a global pharmaceutical company to write the sustainability vision plan for its property portfolio.
- Led pitches, bids and competition entries that won more than £10 million a year in fees as Associate Partner and more than £5 million a year as Associate.
- My presentations to Fortune 500 chief executives helped the design studios win contracts worth more than £10 million.

SUSTAINABILITY AND ENVIRONMENTAL DESIGN

- Served on the whole life carbon leadership team, which taught studio partners how embodied and operational carbon differ, how they divide across construction, operations and transport, how design decisions affect them, and which regulation is coming.
- Developed early design tools that estimate whole life carbon before building elements are designed in enough detail for full analysis.
- Served on the sustainability leadership team that correlated every global rating system the firm works with into one Foster responsibility framework built around ten common themes.
- Worked on projects in the UAE, Qatar and Saudi Arabia under their local rating systems: Estidama Pearl, GSAS and Mostadam.

Skills

SUSTAINABILITY AND ENVIRONMENT

Whole life carbon

Environmental strategy

Building performance modelling

Microclimate and solar analysis

LEED, Pearl, GSAS and Mostadam

ADVISORY AND COMMERCIAL

Building new service lines

Business development and bids

Client relationship management

Executive presentations

PEOPLE AND RESEARCH

Staff training and education

Technology team leadership

University teaching

AI-assisted research

Accreditations

LEED Accredited Professional

Estidama Pearl Qualified Professional

- Contributed to stadium projects including Lusail Stadium in Qatar, San Siro in Milan, Old Trafford in Manchester and a cricket stadium in India.
- Managed environmental strategy, microclimate analysis and computational modelling on large international projects.
- Acted as the main technical contact for international developers and institutional clients, setting building performance targets that fitted their budgets and ESG commitments.

Clients Roche, Genentech, Alibaba, Apple, Oracle, Hyundai, JPMorgan Chase

Tools Rhino 3D, Grasshopper 3D, Revit, Python, C#, Unreal Engine, Claude Code, ChatGPT, Gemini, NotebookLM, Copilot Studio

Skidmore, Owings & Merrill (SOM)

Oct 2013 to Oct 2015

New York

Revenue $347m (2021)

High Performance Design Lead

SOM is a Chicago architecture and engineering firm whose buildings include One World Trade Center.

- Led environmental and building performance strategy for tall buildings and large urban projects in North America and abroad.
- Brought environmental simulation into early design stages to improve energy performance and cut carbon emissions.
- Led business development for my department in the New York office, presented to executives at major Wall Street banks and won more than $3 million a year in fees.

Clients Citigroup, Shenzhen Rural Commercial Bank, Empire State Development

Tools Ladybug Tools, EnergyPlus, DOE 2.2, C#

WSP

Jul 2010 to Oct 2013

New York

Revenue C$18.3bn (2025)

Sustainability Manager, YR&G

WSP is a Montreal engineering and professional services consultancy listed in Toronto.

- Managed sustainability projects for public and private sector clients, including LEED certification and carbon reduction plans.
- Led teams of engineers, energy modellers and environmental analysts on evaluations of multi-property portfolios.
- Won more than $2 million a year in fees through cold and warm outreach, pitches and bids.

Clients ESPN, Lotte, Essence Securities

Tools Radiance, IES Virtual Environment

Rafael Viñoly Architects

Oct 2008 to Jan 2010

New York

Revenue est. $25 to 50m

Computational and Environmental Designer

Rafael Viñoly Architects is a New York practice whose buildings include 432 Park Avenue.

- Led environmental analysis, solar radiation modelling and geometry optimisation for complex projects in North America and Asia.
- Co-founded the firm's Technology Group, which introduced scripting and simulation to its design process.

Tools IES Virtual Environment, RhinoScript, SolidWorks, GenerativeComponents

Education

Show

Building Performance Simulation 2011

Harvard University Graduate School of Design

Certificate in Sustainable Finance 2022

University of Cambridge Institute for Sustainability Leadership

Master of Engineering 2010

Stevens Institute of Technology, Hoboken, New Jersey

Bachelor of Architecture 2004

Iowa State University

AI credentials

Show

ANTHROPIC

AI Fluency · Claude Code in Action · Claude Cowork · Claude Platform

MICROSOFT

Copilot Studio in a Day

Teaching

Show

Industry Partner Instructor

Imperial College London, Civil and Environmental Engineering

Associate Adjunct Professor

City University of New York

Program Lead

New York College of Technology

Graduate Consultant

Harvard GSD, Penn Design and Columbia

Presentations

Show

2012	**Intersections** Speaker, then panel moderator in 2013
2017	**Bâtiment durable Québec** Lecture on 6D BIM design
2018	**BPAC and SimBuild** Keynote on building performance simulation
2021	**COP26 Buildings Pavilion** Two sessions on net zero carbon and whole life carbon, with Chris Trott
	Dezeen and Velux panel Panel on COP26 and cities, with Chris Trott
2022	**LCA Forum** Organised the London meeting
2023	**One Click LCA Bootcamp** Panel on life cycle assessment
	UN COP28, Dubai Lecture on sustainable architecture
	CoreNet Global Summit Listed speaker, Dubai
Undated	**Foster + Partners Earth Day and COP Week** Chaired panels
	Innovation Zero With Chris Trott

ALSO

Center for Architecture New York
Qatar
Moscow Urban Forum
Brookfield
Imperial College, Civil Engineering

Publications and media

Show

SimAUD 2015 2015

Paper on low-energy high-rise residential design in megacities

LinkedIn articles

On life-cycle design and façades

Interviews 2013 to 2019

ArchDaily, Designalyze and Covetool